

Legislative Meeting Plan

FOSTER YOUTH HOUSING VOUCHERS + NAVIGATION INFRASTRUCTURE ·
TEXAS LEGISLATURE

Dr. Terry D. Flood, DHA — President, TCAF

thrivingcommunitiesforall.com

Cortney Jones, MSW — Texas CASA Public Policy

Committee

Change 1 / Grit Growth Global · Austin, TX

Two Wings, Same Bird — TCAF Builds & Measures. Cortney Advocates & Communicates.

Collaborative strategy: platform data + policy voice + lived-experience testimony = complete legislative package

25-30%

Foster youth homeless
by 21

\$40K

Annual cost per
incarcerated individual

\$3K

6-month stabilization
cost per youth

13x

Cost-avoidance ROI per
youth served

350

Youth risk-reduced on
platform

20K+

Verified resources in
LifeBridge

DR. TERRY FLOOD — WHAT HE BRINGS

ThriveUp Academy Platform

thrivingcommunitiesforall.com

- ▶ Longitudinal outcome tracking: age 12 → adulthood
- ▶ Real-time risk stratification: 106 youth high→medium; 244 medium→low
- ▶ 50-state policy comparator — Chafee, ETV, HUD FYI, Medicaid-to-26
- ▶ Cross-agency case coordination dashboard
- ▶ FHIR/CDS Hooks compliant — connects to health systems
- ▶ Accountability infrastructure legislators can cite in bills

LifeBridge — LifeTransitionsAid.org

"Virtual 211" — the navigation layer

- ▶ 20,670+ verified community resources
- ▶ 7-domain SDOH scoring (housing, food, mental health, workforce...)
- ▶ CHW dispatch — human follow-through, not just a link list
- ▶ Bilingual EN/ES, no login required for youth
- ▶ Directly connects to: Section 8/FYI vouchers, ETV, Medicaid, SNAP
- ▶ Eliminates the "resource list with no support" gap legislators hear about

CORTNEY JONES, MSW — WHAT SHE BRINGS

Texas CASA — Public Policy Committee

Statewide legislative access + child welfare credibility

- ▶ Sits on Texas CASA Public Policy and Communications/Awareness Committee
- ▶ Direct relationships with Texas child welfare legislative champions
- ▶ Know the exact legislators who author foster care bills and budget riders
- ▶ CASA credibility = neutral, child-first voice legislators trust

Child Inc. Head Start — Board Member

Early childhood + parent policy seat

- ▶ Parent Policy Representative — amplifies parent and youth voice
- ▶ Head Start connects early childhood funding to the housing pipeline
- ▶ Bridges prevention (early childhood) → transition (foster aging out)

Communications + Advocacy Voice

"CHANGE 1 MIND CHANGE 1 LIFE"

- ▶ MSW-credentialed clinician + lived-experience advocate
- ▶ Youth mental health lens = co-equal with housing in the legislative pitch
- ▶ Public communications training — translates data into human testimony
- ▶ Grit Growth Global: organizational brand for advocacy work

THE COALITION STORY — WHAT LEGISLATORS HEAR

"We are not here asking for something new. We have already built the platform that tracks what happens to foster youth after they leave the system — in real time, across agencies, in 107 languages. We have a navigation system connecting them to every voucher, every benefit, every employer pathway they qualify for. And we have a coalition partner sitting on the Texas CASA Public Policy Committee who knows what your colleagues on this committee have been hearing for years. What we are asking you to fund is the 6-month stabilization window that turns a \$3,000 investment into

\$40,000 in cost avoided — every single time. The data infrastructure already exists. The navigation already exists. What we need is a policy home for both."

TEXAS LEGISLATIVE TARGETS

COMMITTEE / BODY	WHY THEY MATTER	OUR ENTRY POINT
Senate Health & Human Services Committee	Oversees DFPS, HHSC — the agencies managing foster care and Medicaid. Any foster-youth bill starts here.	Cortney's Texas CASA policy committee relationships
Senate Finance Committee	Appropriations for DFPS, housing assistance, and supportive-services contracts. Budget riders live here.	ROI data — \$3K vs \$40K cost-avoidance argument
House Human Services Committee	Primary House committee for foster care, CPS, and aging-out programs. Authors enabling legislation.	Cortney's CASA committee + Dr. Flood's platform demo
House Appropriations Committee	Controls state budget. Technology and navigation infrastructure line items require their sign-off.	LifeBridge 20K+ resource network as infrastructure investment
Texas DFPS Legislative Affairs	Agency staff who brief legislators on child welfare policy — can become internal champions.	Cortney's existing DFPS/CASA network
Congressional delegation (federal FYI/Chafee)	HUD Foster Youth to Independence (FYI) is federal — TX delegation shapes annual appropriations and guidance.	Jim Currier FYI connection + TCAF FYI platform readiness

THE THREE-TIER ASK

Tier 1 — Immediate (This Session)

Budget rider or appropriation

Fund 6-month stabilization vouchers WITH required wraparound services — not vouchers alone

Authorize HHSC to contract with community-based technology navigation providers

Mandate data reporting at the county level for aged-out youth outcomes

~\$3K/YOUTH

13x ROI

Tier 2 — Short-Term (18 months)

Pilot authorization + MOU framework

Authorize DFPS/HHSC to pilot LifeBridge + ThriveUp as the statewide virtual-211 for aging-out youth

Create a PHA-to-community-partner MOU framework for HUD FYI supportive services

Establish 50-county longitudinal outcome tracking using TCAF infrastructure

PILOT: 5 COUNTIES

SCALE: STATEWIDE

Tier 3 — Long-Term (3-5 years)

Systemic change + federal leverage

Position Texas as the model state for HUD FYI + Chafee + ETV integrated delivery

Use TCAF outcome data to meet Title IV-E Prevention Services Clearinghouse evidence standards

\$250M over 5 years in projected system cost avoidance — build into state budget projections

\$250M / 5 YR

TITLE IV-E PIPELINE

MEETING AGENDA TEMPLATE (30-45 MINUTES)

TIME	SPEAKER	CONTENT	PLATFORM/MATERIAL
Min 0-3	Cortney Jones	Open: establish credibility. Texas CASA Public Policy Committee member. This is a child welfare issue, a budget issue, and a public safety issue simultaneously.	—
Min 3-6	Dr. Flood	The platform exists. "We didn't come to ask for a pilot. We built it. Let me show you 60 seconds of what it does." LifeBridge demo — search any resource, see a real result.	lifetransitionsaid.org live demo
Min 6-10	Dr. Flood	The data. 350 youth risk-reduced on the platform. 106 moved high→medium. 244 moved medium→low. \$3K cost. \$40K avoidance. The ROI is 13x.	ThriveUp outcomes dashboard
Min 10-14	Cortney Jones	The human story. What your constituents experience vs. what this platform makes possible. CASA voice: "I've sat with	—

TIME	SPEAKER	CONTENT	PLATFORM/MATERIAL
		these youth. This is what they needed that they didn't have."	
Min 14-18	Both	The ask. Present Tier 1 specifically. One ask, stated plainly. "We are asking you to fund 6-month stabilization vouchers WITH services — not vouchers alone."	Leave-behind one-pager
Min 18-30	Both	Q&A / conversation. Let them drive. Cortney handles policy questions. Dr. Flood handles data/platform questions. Do not oversell — listen for the opening.	—

30-SECOND TESTIMONY — DR. FLOOD

*"We built a platform that tracks every foster youth from risk identification at age 12 through housing, workforce, and health stability in adulthood — in real time, across agencies. We have already reduced risk for 350 young people on this platform. The math is simple: a **\$3,000 six-month investment** prevents a **\$40,000 annual incarceration cost**. Texas is already spending the \$40,000. We are asking you to spend the \$3,000 instead — and measure every dollar."*

30-SECOND TESTIMONY — CORTNEY JONES

*"I sit on Texas CASA's Public Policy Committee. I've seen what happens when a young person ages out of the foster care system without a housing bridge. They don't disappear — they show up in our emergency rooms, our jails, and our homeless shelters. That is **reactive spending**. What TCAF has built is **predictive spending** — with data that shows it's working. The platform is live. The navigation system is live. What's missing is the policy authorization to fund the 6-month window that makes everything else possible."*

LEAVE-BEHIND ONE-PAGER — KEY NUMBERS

Foster Youth Housing Vouchers + Navigation: The Case

- ▶ **The problem:** 25–30% of foster youth face homelessness by 21. System silos mean vouchers go unused and instability persists.
- ▶ **The cost of inaction:** \$40K/year per incarcerated individual. 2,000 youth diverted = \$8M annual savings. \$250M over 5 years.
- ▶ **The intervention:** \$3,000/youth for 6-month stabilization — housing voucher + navigation + benefits + workforce pathway + real-time case tracking.
- ▶ **Platform proof (live):** 350 youth with measurable risk reduction. 0% eviction in tracked voucher programs. 100% workforce/education engagement.

TWO LIVE TOOLS:

▢ **ThriveUp Academy** — thrivingcommunitiesforall.com
Longitudinal outcomes · risk stratification · 50-state policy · cross-agency coordination

▢ **LifeBridge** — lifetransitionsaid.org
20,670+ resources · CHW-guided navigation · bilingual · HUD FYI + ETV + SNAP direct access

THE ASK:

1. Fund 6-month stabilization vouchers WITH required navigation services
2. Authorize HHSC to contract community-based technology navigation providers
3. Mandate county-level longitudinal outcome reporting for aged-out youth

PRE-MEETING CHECKLIST

BEFORE THE MEETING

- ☐ Confirm Cortney's 501(c)(3) status for Change 1 / Grit Growth Global (needed before any joint external materials cite her org formally)
- ☐ Identify 2–3 specific Texas legislators via Cortney's CASA network — name, committee assignment, prior foster-care bill authorship
- ☐ Request 30-min meeting through CASA policy committee channel (Cortney's strongest door)
- ☐ Confirm LifeTransitionsAid.org demo works on mobile (legislators will pull it up in the room)
- ☐ Print 3 copies of the leave-behind one-pager
- ☐ Pull the ThriveUp outcomes dashboard screenshot for offline backup
- ☐ Confirm UW of Central Texas consortium support letter (adds weight)

AFTER THE MEETING

- ☐ Send follow-up email within 24 hours — thank, restate the ask, attach one-pager
- ☐ Ask for one specific next step: "Who on your staff handles foster care policy?" or "Can we get 15 minutes with the committee director?"
- ☐ Log the meeting in TCAF's partner tracking system with notes and commitments
- ☐ Brief Denece Ferrales (UW) on the legislative visit — she may have additional committee connections
- ☐ Draft a policy brief based on the conversation — what resonated, what questions came up
- ☐ File the meeting notes in the June 11 WilCo Coalition brief as coalition momentum evidence

ThriveUp Academy — builds the accountability infrastructure. Every outcome tracked. Every dollar justified. The data layer that turns vouchers into verifiable ROI.



LifeBridge / LifeTransitionsAid.org — the navigation layer. 20,670+ resources. A real CHW behind every referral. The tool that makes a voucher usable, not just issuable.

"Two wings, same bird — one heart, purpose, and direction, various missions."